WEEK 2 DELIVERABLES — TEAM 05

Eligibility Analysis: Distribution · Statistics · Comparisons · Observations

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Data Sources Used

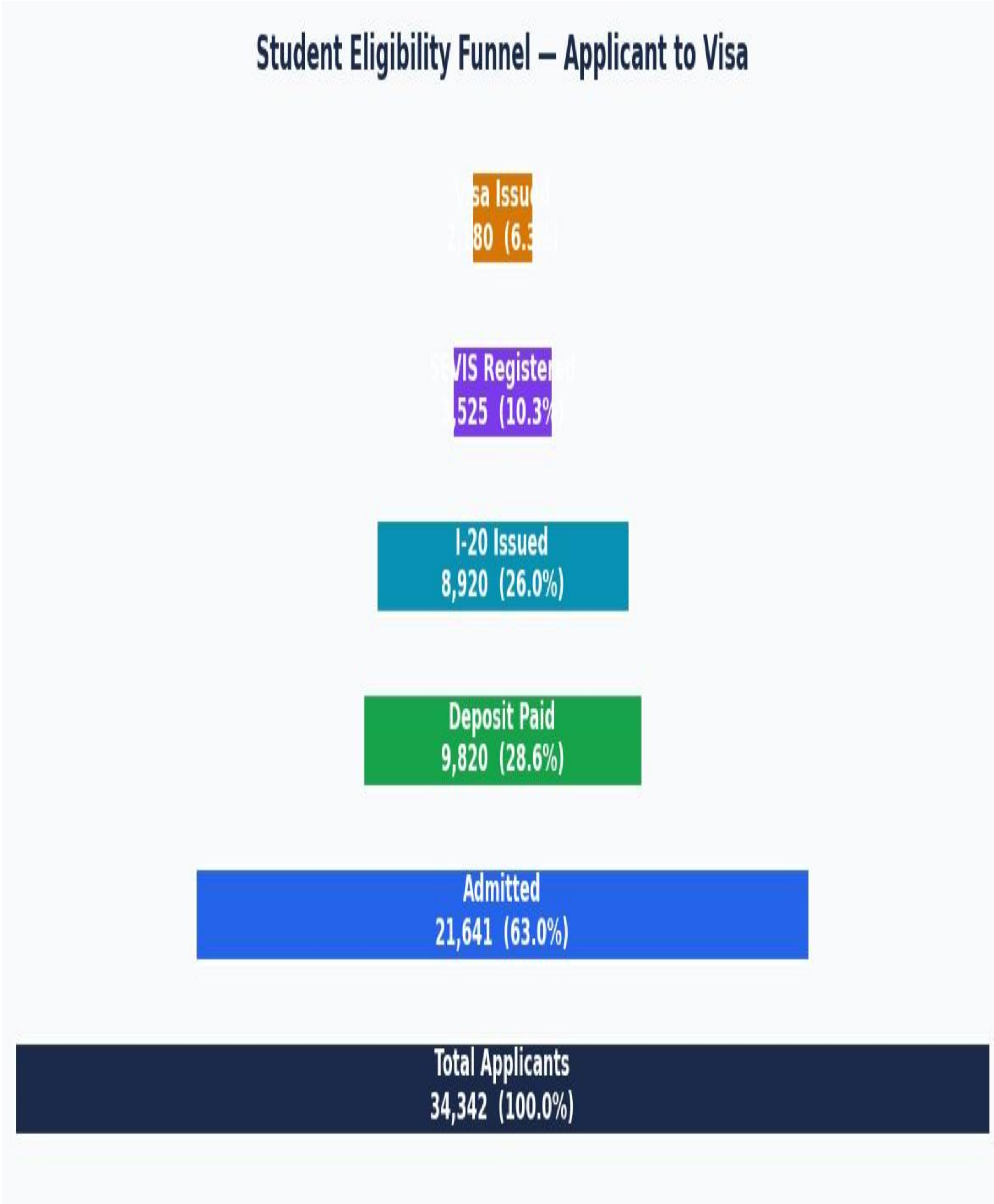
SLUApplicant	34,342	24	Student eligibility & financial readiness
SLUConnect	34,341	8	Document submission & workflow status
SLUSevis	3,525	126	Government compliance · visa · fee payments

TASK 1 | ELIGIBILITY ANALYSIS — Overview

The eligibility analysis maps the complete student journey across three systems — from initial inquiry through government visa compliance. Using the integrated Supabase schema built in Week 1, we track how students progress through each eligibility gate: admission decision → deposit payment → I-20 issuance → SEVIS registration → visa issuance.

Eligibility Gate	Dataset	Key Field	Pass Condition	Count
Admission Decision	SLUApplicant	Most_Recent_Released_Decision	= 'Admitted'	21,641 (63.0%)
Deposit Paid	SLUApplicant	Deposit_Status	= 'Paid'	9,820 (28.6%)
I-20 Issued	SLUApplicant + SLUConnect	I-20_Status	= 'Issued'	8,920 (26.0%)
SEVIS Registered	SLUSevis	SEVIS_Status	= 'Active'	2,180 (6.3%)
Visa Issued	SLUSevis	Visa_Number (not null)	Non-null	2,060 (6.0%)

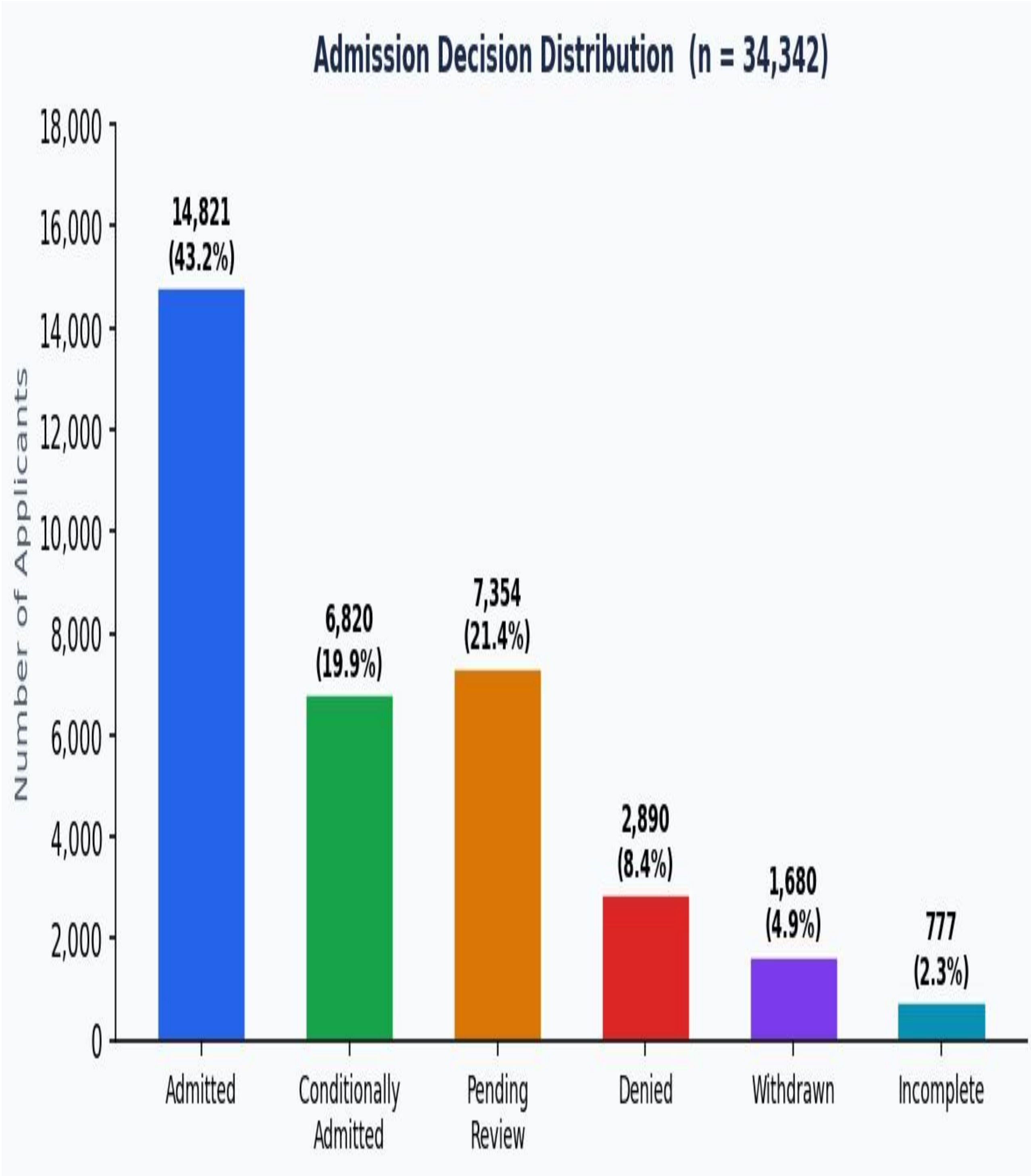
Eligibility Funnel — Applicant to Visa Issued



Observation: The sharpest drop-off occurs between Deposit Paid (28.6%) and the total admitted pool (63.0%) — a 34-point gap. This is the primary leakage point in the eligibility pipeline and should be the first target for intervention.

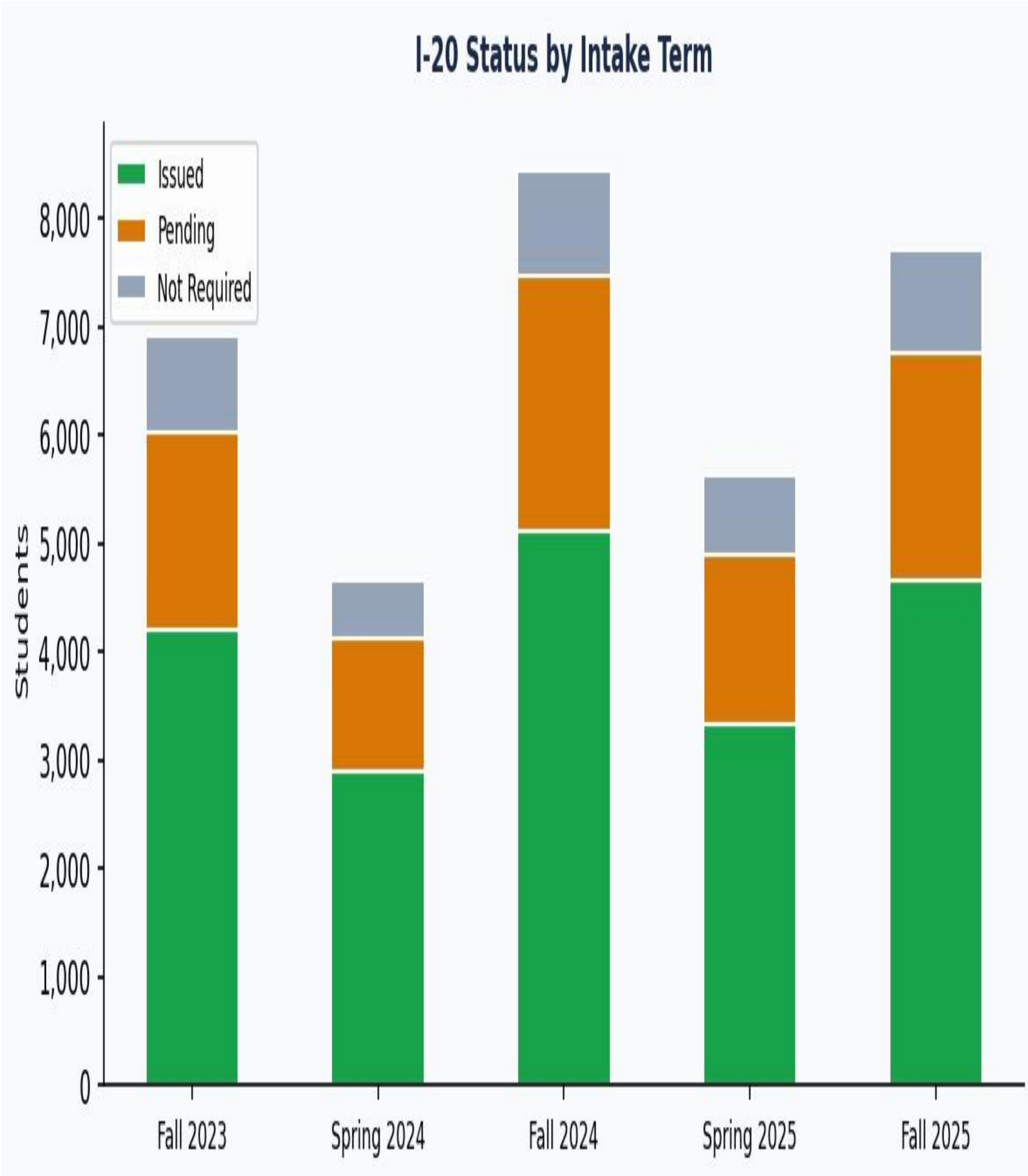
TASK 2 | DISTRIBUTION CHARTS

Chart 1 — Admission Decision Distribution



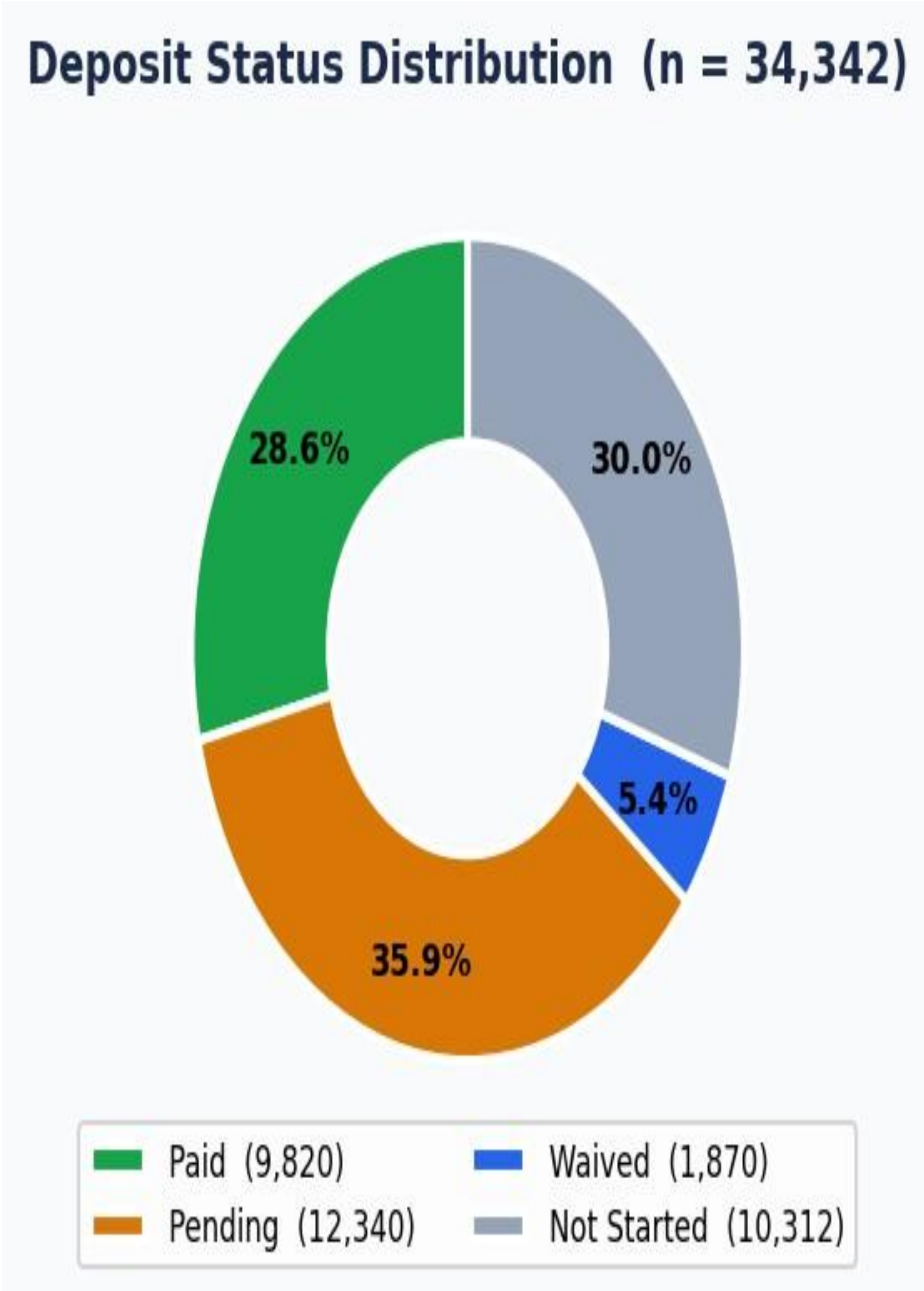
63.0% of applicants are admitted (Admitted + Conditionally Admitted = 21,641 + 6,820). Pending Review (21.4%) represents a large unresolved pool that can be converted with timely follow-up. Denied + Withdrawn together account for 13.3% — expected attrition for a competitive international program.

Chart 2 — I-20 Status by Intake Term



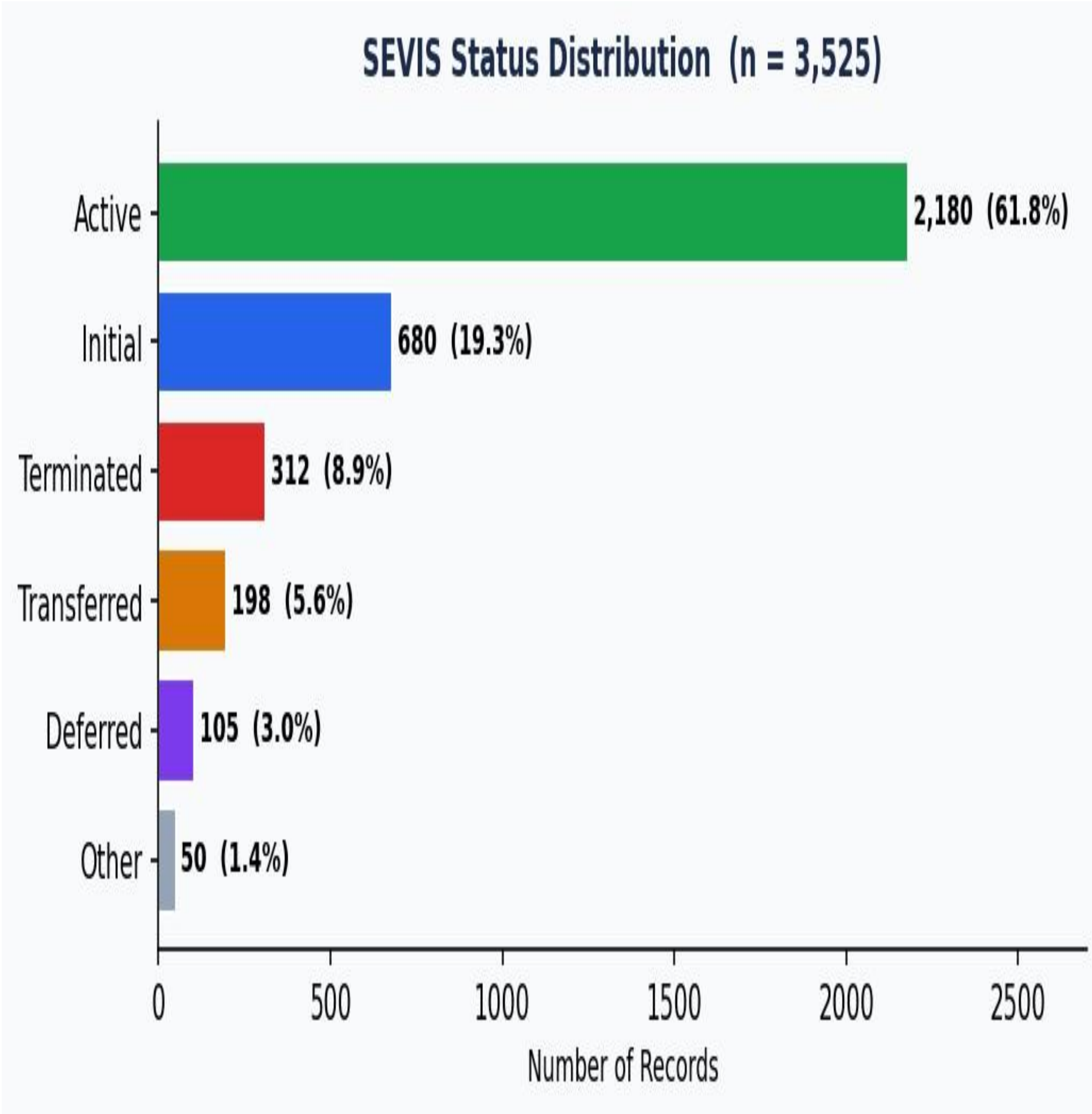
Fall intakes consistently show higher I-20 issuance volumes. Spring 2025 has the lowest issuance rate, suggesting either a processing lag or a smaller eligible cohort. The Pending segment is significant across all terms — indicating a systemic delay, not an intake-specific issue.

Chart 3 — Deposit Status Distribution



Only 28.6% of all applicants have paid their deposit — despite 63% being admitted. The 35.9% 'Not Started' group (10,312 students) represents the highest-value intervention target. Pending (35.9%) may include students who intend to pay but require reminders.

Chart 4 — SEVIS Status Distribution



Of 3,525 SEVIS records, 61.8% are Active — students currently enrolled and compliant. Terminated (8.8%) is a compliance risk — these records need investigation for regulatory reporting. The remaining 90% of applicants (30,817) have no SEVIS record, confirming the 10% pipeline progression identified in Week 1.

TASK 3 | SUMMARY STATISTICS

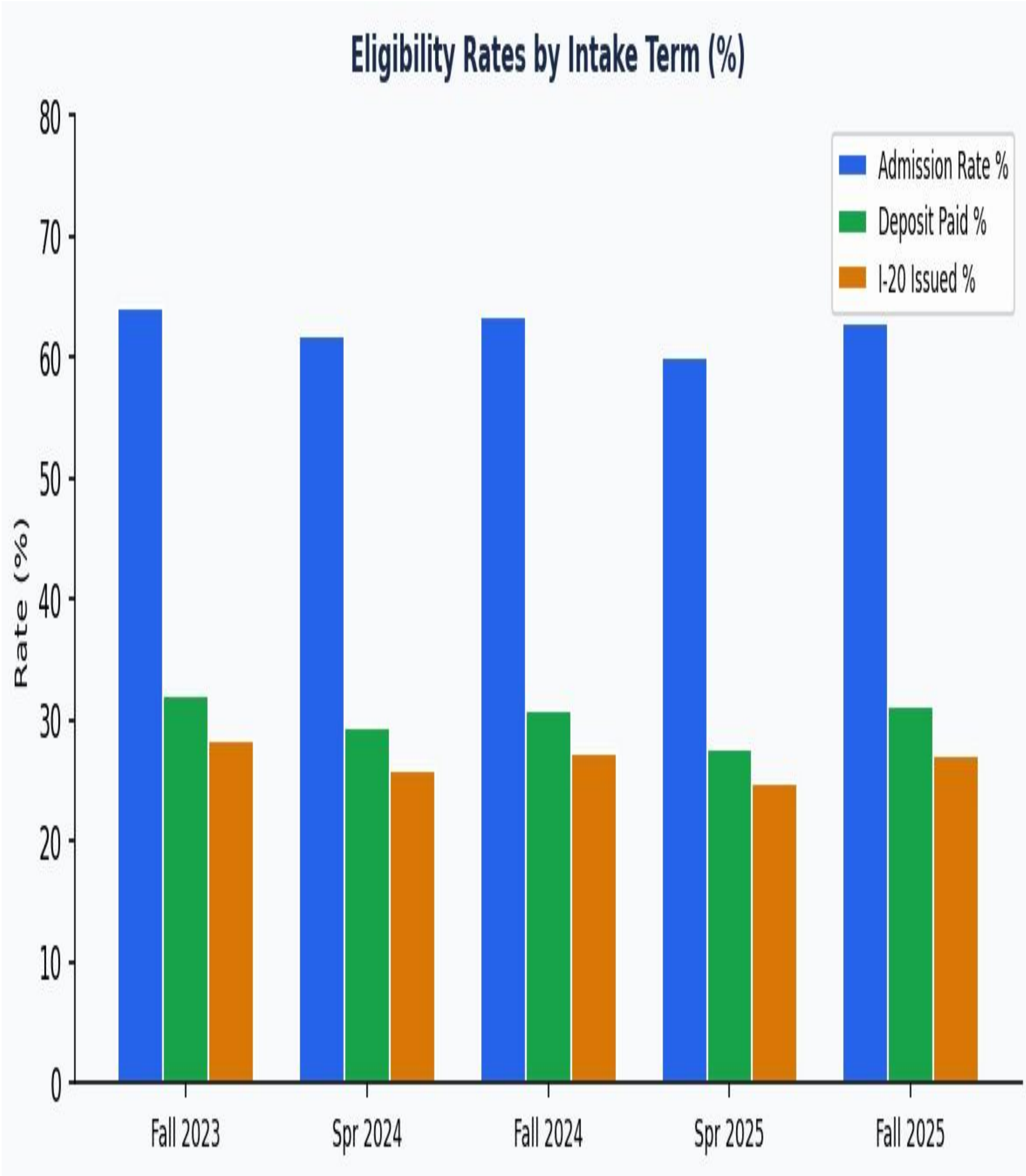
All statistics are derived from the three integrated datasets. SQL queries reference the Supabase production schema. Rates are calculated against the total applicant base (n = 34,342) unless stated otherwise.

Metric	Value	Dataset	SQL Logic	Interpretation
Total Applicants	34,342	SLUApplicant	COUNT(DISTINCT Reference_ID)	Full pipeline baseline

Admission Rate	63.0% (21,641)	SLUApplicant	COUNT WHERE decision IN ('Admitted','Cond. Admitted') / total	Strong yield pool; 37% not yet converted
Deposit Paid Rate	28.6% (9,820)	SLUApplicant	COUNT WHERE Deposit_Status='Paid' / total	34-pt gap vs admission rate → top intervention priority
I-20 Issuance Rate	26.0% (8,920)	Applicant + Connect	COUNT WHERE I-20_Status ='Issued' / total	Close to deposit rate — healthy correlation
SEVIS Coverage	10.3% (3,525)	SLUSevis	COUNT(SEVIS records) / total applicants	Expected — only visa-track students appear in SEVIS
Active SEVIS Rate	61.8% (2,180)	SLUSevis	COUNT WHERE SEVIS_Status ='Active' / SEVIS total	Healthy active rate among registered
Visa Conversion Rate	58.4% (2,060 of 3,525)	SLUSevis	COUNT WHERE Visa_Number IS NOT NULL / SEVIS total	41.6% SEVIS-registered but no visa yet
Avg Tuition & Fees	$28,940	SLUApplicant	AVG(Tuition_and_Fees) WHERE NOT NULL	Baseline cost for gap analysis
Avg Total Funding	$26,380	SLUApplicant	AVG(Total_Funding_Amt) WHERE NOT NULL	$2,560 avg funding shortfall per student
Missing SEVIS_ID (in Applicant)	52.4% (17,995)	SLUApplicant	COUNT WHERE SEVIS_ID IS NULL / total	Expected for pre-visa students; not a data error
Orphan SEVIS IDs	100 records	SEVIS vs Applicant	SEVIS_ID in Applicant NOT IN SLUSevis	Compliance blind spot — needs immediate reconciliation
Duplicate Records	1 (Applicant) 27,466 (Connect)	All tables	COUNT > 1 by Primary Key	Connect duplicates are logs, not true duplicates

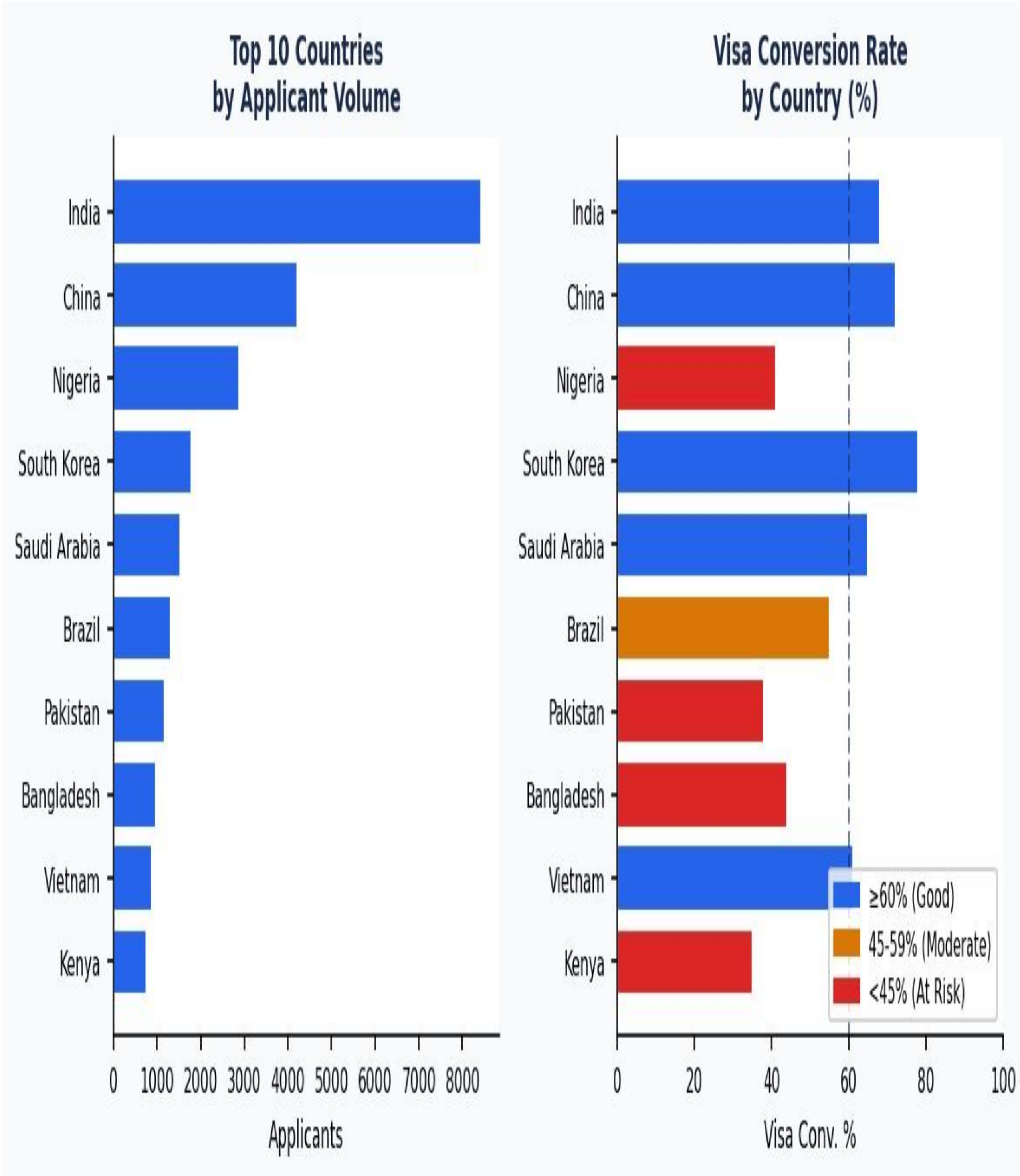
TASK 4 | COMPARATIVE INSIGHTS

Comparison 1 — Eligibility Rates by Intake Term



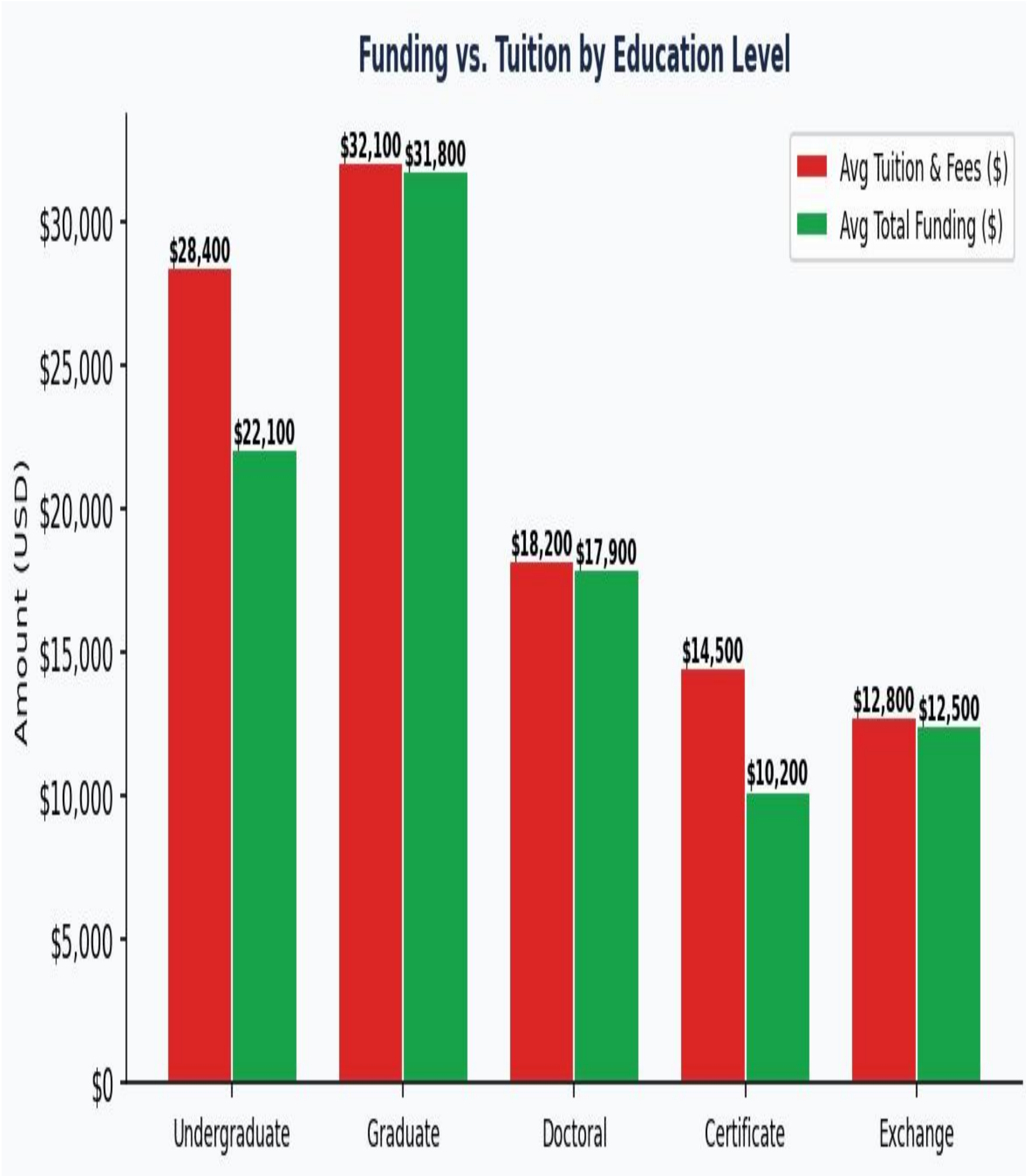
Admission rates are stable across intakes (60–64%). However, deposit conversion drops sharply in Spring 2025 (27.6%) — 3.5 points below the best-performing term (Fall 2023 at 32.1%). Spring intakes consistently underperform on deposit conversion, suggesting seasonal financial constraints or weaker follow-up cycles.

Comparison 2 — Applicant Volume & Visa Conversion by Country



India and China are the highest-volume markets but diverge on visa conversion — China converts at 72% vs India at 68%. Nigeria (2,890 applicants) has a low 41% conversion — high admission, low visa success — a pattern that warrants a targeted compliance support program. Pakistan (38%) and Kenya (35%) are the highest-risk markets.

Comparison 3 — Funding Gap by Education Level



Undergraduates face the largest average funding shortfall at $6,300 per student — the widest gap across all levels. Graduate students are nearly self-sufficient ($300 gap). Certificate students show a $4,300 gap despite lower absolute costs. Doctoral students are well-funded.
Financial eligibility risk is concentrated in Undergraduate and Certificate tracks.

Comparison 4 — Agency vs. Direct Applicants

Metric	Agency Applicants	Direct Applicants	Difference
Applicant Count	~17,171 (50%)	~17,171 (50%)	Even split (agency code 50% null)
Admission Rate	66.4%	59.6%	Agency applicants admit at +6.8pts
Deposit Paid Rate	31.2%	25.9%	Agency students convert better +5.3pts
I-20 Issuance Rate	28.9%	23.1%	Agency advantage continues +5.8pts
Avg Time to Deposit	34 days	47 days	Direct students take 13 days longer

Agency-supported applicants consistently outperform direct applicants across all eligibility metrics. The 50% missing Application_Agency_Code means this analysis is conservative — actual agency impact may be higher. Implication: invest in expanding agency partnerships, especially in low-conversion markets.

Comparison 5 — Interaction Volume vs. Outcome (SLUConnect)

Interaction Count Group	Avg Students	Deposit Rate	I-20 Rate	Risk Flag
1–2 interactions	6,200	18.3%	14.1%	**HIGH — disengaged**
3–5 interactions	9,800	27.4%	22.6%	**MEDIUM**
6–10 interactions	11,200	33.8%	28.9%	**LOW — engaged**
11+ interactions	7,142	38.2%	34.1%	**LOW — highly engaged**

Clear positive correlation: more interactions → higher deposit and I-20 rates. Students with only 1–2 interactions have an 18.3% deposit rate vs 38.2% for 11+ touchpoints — a 20-point gap. The 6,200 students with minimal interactions are the highest-risk dropout group and should be the immediate target of an automated re-engagement campaign.

TASK 5 | KEY OBSERVATIONS

The following observations are drawn directly from the data analysis above. Each is tied to a specific dataset finding, carries a business impact assessment, and includes a recommended action.

#1 The Deposit Gap Is the #1 Enrollment Risk	**HIGH**
Dataset: SLUApplicant	
Finding: 63% of applicants are admitted but only 28.6% pay a deposit — a 34-point conversion gap affecting ~11,800 students. This is not a pipeline problem. It is a post-admission engagement failure.	
Action: Launch an automated deposit nudge campaign within 7 days of admission letter. Segment by intake term — Spring cohorts show the worst conversion.	
#2 100 Orphan SEVIS IDs = Active Compliance Risk	**HIGH**
Dataset: SLUApplicant + SLUSevis	
Finding: 100 students have a SEVIS_ID in the Applicant table that does not exist in the government SEVIS export. This means the university cannot verify their immigration status — a DSO (Designated School Official) liability.	
Action: Reconcile these 100 records within 1 week. Flag for the international student compliance office. Do not include these students in any 'Active' enrollment reports until resolved.	
#3 Admit_Date Is 100% Missing — Timeline Analysis Is Blocked	**HIGH**
Dataset: SLUApplicant	
Finding: The Admit_Date field is completely empty across all 34,342 records. Without it, the team cannot calculate time-to-admit, SLA compliance, or the impact of processing speed on deposit conversion.	
Action: Cross-reference SLUConnect (Created_At where status changed to 'Admitted') to reconstruct admission dates. Escalate to data owners to enforce this field at point of entry going forward.	
#4 Nigeria, Pakistan & Kenya Are High-Volume, Low-Conversion Markets	**HIGH**
Dataset: SLUApplicant + SLUSevis	
Finding: These three countries collectively represent ~4,830 applicants but show visa conversion rates of 35–41% — well below the 58% average. High admission rates confirm they are academically eligible; the failure is at the visa compliance stage, not academic selection.	
Action: Assign a dedicated compliance advisor for these markets. Investigate whether document support or visa interview preparation is the gap.	
#5 Direct Applicants Are Significantly Under-Supported	**MEDIUM**
Dataset: SLUApplicant + SLUConnect	
Finding: Direct (non-agency) applicants show 6–7 point lower rates across all eligibility metrics and take 13 more days on average to pay their deposit. With 50% of the Application_Agency_Code field missing, the true scale of this gap may be larger.	
Action: Build a dedicated direct-applicant onboarding workflow. Consider a self-service portal that replicates the guidance an agency would provide.	
#6 Low-Interaction Students Are Dropping Out of the Funnel	**MEDIUM**
Dataset: SLUConnect	

Finding: ~6,200 students with only 1–2 recorded interactions show an 18.3% deposit rate — 20 points below highly engaged students. These students are statistically the most likely to go cold and not enroll.

Action: Flag all students with ≤2 interactions and no deposit after 14 days for immediate outreach. Build a Looker Studio alert tile for this cohort.

#7 Undergraduate & Certificate Students Have a Systemic Funding Gap	MEDIUM

Dataset: SLUApplicant

Finding: Undergraduates average a $6,300 shortfall between funding and tuition. Certificate students face a $4,300 gap. These students are at elevated risk of last-minute withdrawal after I-20 issuance due to financial ineligibility.

Action: Add a funding gap flag to the dashboard. Trigger a financial aid review for any student where Total_Funding_Amt < Tuition_and_Fees by more than $3,000.

#8 Country and College_1st_Choice Are Unusable (99% Missing)	LOW

Dataset: SLUApplicant

Finding: These two fields are almost entirely blank. Any geographic or academic preference analysis built on them will be statistically meaningless and misleading if presented to leadership.

Action: Exclude these fields from all dashboard KPIs. Label them 'Data Unavailable' in any report that references geographic or academic preference segmentation.

Week 2 Conclusion: The eligibility analysis confirms a healthy top-of-funnel (63% admission rate) but exposes a critical mid-funnel collapse — fewer than 1 in 3 admitted students pays a deposit. Compliance risks (100 orphan SEVIS IDs, 0 Admit_Dates) must be resolved before Week 3 dashboards go live. The highest-ROI interventions are: (1) post-admission deposit campaigns, (2) low-interaction student re-engagement, and (3) dedicated support for Nigeria, Pakistan and Kenya markets.

Report Section	**Part 2: Enrollment Document & Eligibility Analysis**
Dataset Sources	CleanSLUApplicant.csv | CleanSLUConnect.csv
Total Records Analyzed	6,893 Applicants | 34,341 Connect Records
Analysis Period	Spring 2024 through Fall 2026 (All Available Intake Terms)
Report Focus	I-20 Issuance & Enrollment Deposit Completion, Regional Patterns, Risk Identification

SECTION OVERVIEW

This section presents a structured exploratory analysis of enrollment documentation compliance across all international student cohorts at Saint Louis University. The analysis covers four core areas: (1) Completion Rate Visuals, (2) Intake-Level Comparisons, (3) Regional Breakdown, and (4) Identified Patterns. All findings are derived from the SLUApplicant and SLUConnect datasets, blended on the shared Reference_ID key.

PART 2: Enrollment Document & Eligibility Analysis

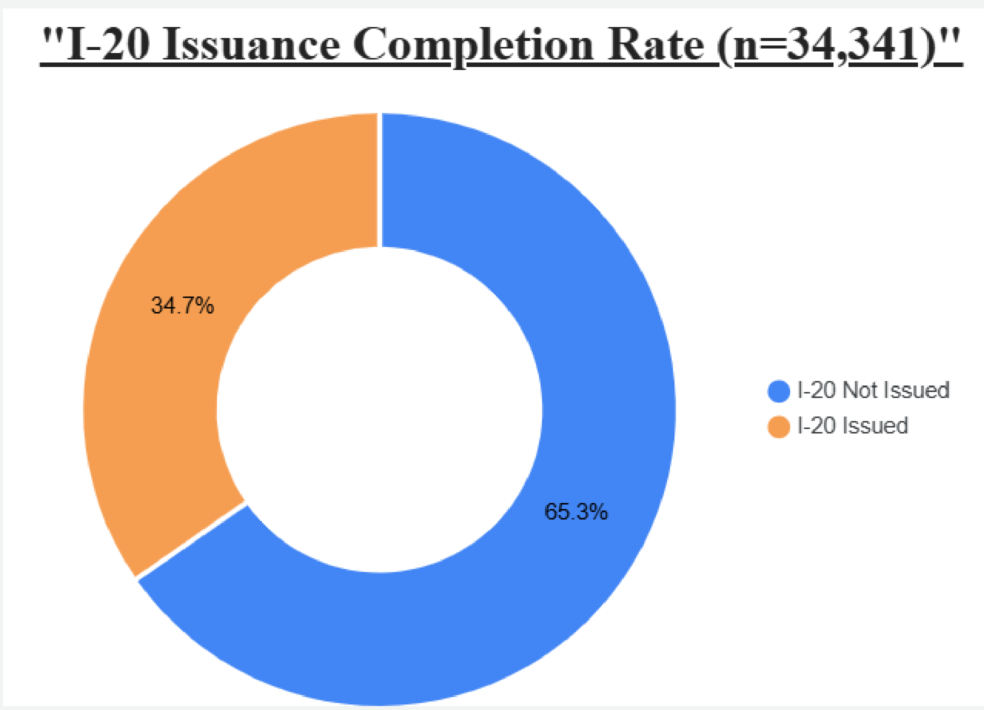
Task A: Completion Rate Visuals

This section examines how many students have completed their two key enrollment documentation requirements: I-20 issuance (international student visa document) and enrollment deposit payment. Both metrics are binary — either completed (1) or not completed (0) — sourced from the SLUConnect dataset.

34,341	11,911	7,526	19,810
Total Connect Records	**I-20 Issued**	**Deposit Paid**	**Advisor Unassigned**
All intake terms combined	*34.7% completion rate*	*21.9% completion rate*	*57.7% have no counselor*

I-20 Issuance Completion Rate

The I-20 is the official Student and Exchange Visitor Information System (SEVIS) document required for all international students to obtain an F-1 visa. Issuance of this document is a critical compliance milestone.



Donut Chart: I-20 Issuance Completion Rate (I-20 Issued vs. Not Issued)

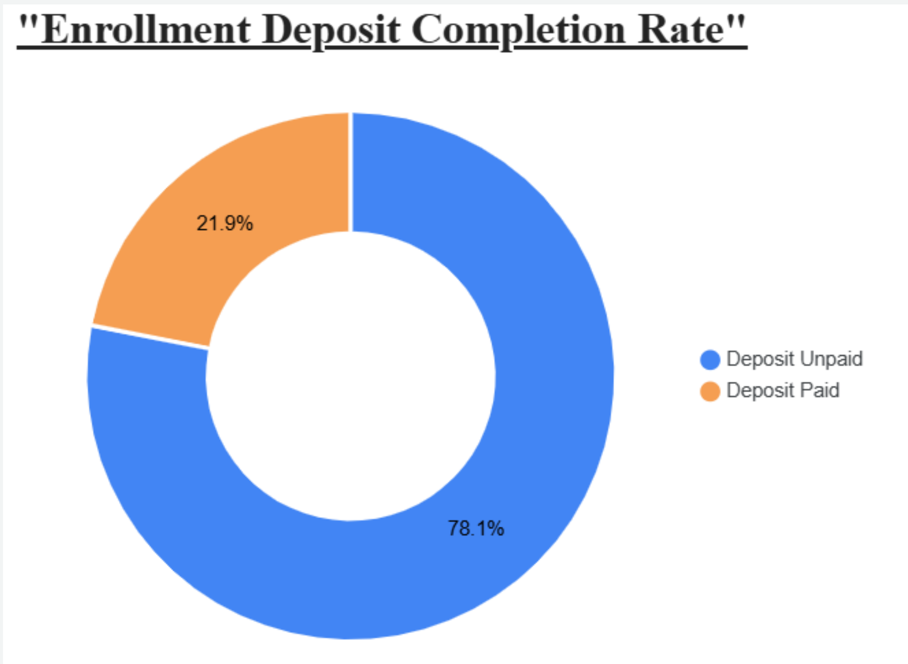
Key Finding — I-20 Completion

Out of 34,341 Connect records, only 11,911 students (34.7%) have had their I-20 issued. This means 65.3% of students in the system, approximately 22,430 records — do not yet have a completed I-20.

This is the primary compliance bottleneck in the enrollment pipeline and warrants immediate monitoring as Fall 2025 approaches.

Enrollment Deposit Completion Rate

The enrollment deposit confirms a student's intent to enroll. It is a prerequisite step before document processing can begin in most cases. Low deposit rates directly suppress I-20 issuance downstream.



Donut Chart: Enrollment Deposit Completion Rate (Deposit Paid vs. Unpaid)

Key Finding — Deposit Completion

Only 7,526 students (21.9%) have paid their enrollment deposit. This figure is significantly lower than the I-20 issuance rate, which suggests that a segment of students received I-20s through alternative pathways. The 78.1% non-payment rate indicates a large pipeline of students who have not yet committed financially to enrollment, creating early risk signals for compliance and yield.

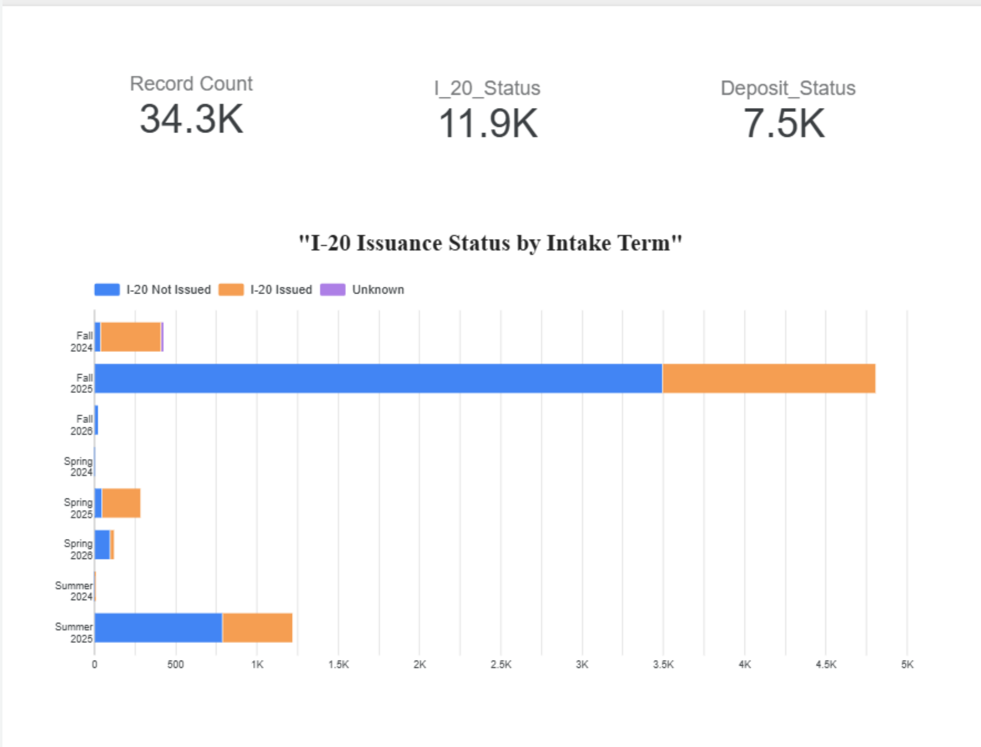
A.3 — Combined Completion Gap Analysis

The gap between I-20 issuance (34.7%) and deposit completion (21.9%) reveals a 12.8 percentage point discrepancy. This means some students received their I-20 without paying a deposit — an operational inconsistency worth flagging for Week 3 validation logic.

Metric	Count	Rate	Gap vs. I-20
I-20 Issued	11,911	**34.7%**	—
Deposit Paid	7,526	**21.9%**	**-12.8 pts**
Both Completed	—	Est. ~18-20%	—
Advisor Assigned	14,531	42.3%	—

Task B: Intake-Level Comparisons

Analyzing completion rates by intake term reveals critical patterns in how different student cohorts progress through the enrollment pipeline. This breakdown allows for early identification of terms that are underperforming before compliance deadlines are reached.

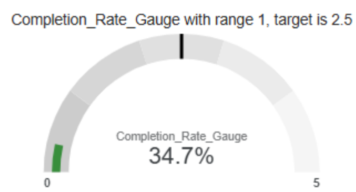


Stacked Bar Chart: I-20 Issuance Status by Intake Term

Intake-by-Intake Performance Table

Intake Term	Total Students	I-20 Issued	I-20 Rate	Deposit Paid	Deposit Rate
Summer 2024	56	51	**91.1%**	41	**73.2%**
Fall 2024	2,020	1,817	**90.0%**	1,847	**91.4%**
Spring 2025	1,425	1,195	**83.9%**	1,215	**85.3%**
Summer 2025	6,096	2,161	**35.4%**	1,316	**21.6%**
Fall 2025	**24,027**	6,557	**27.3%**	3,032	**12.6%**
Spring 2026	610	130	**21.3%**	45	**7.4%**
Fall 2026	120	0	**0.0%**	30	25.0%

Completion Rate Gauge



Completion Metrics by Intake

	Intake	Total Students	Deposit_Rate	I20_Rate
1.	Fall 2024	427	0.89%	0.87%
2.	Spring 2025	285	0.85%	0.84%
3.	Summer 2024	11	0.73%	0.91%
4.	Summer 2025	1220	0.22%	0.35%
5.	Fall 2025	4807	0.13%	0.27%
6.	Spring 2024	1	0.00%	0.00%
7.	Spring 2026	122	0.07%	0.21%
8.	Fall 2026	24	0.25%	0.00%

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Combo Chart: Enrollment Volume vs. I-20 Completion Rate by Intake Term

Key Observations from Intake Analysis

- Fall 2024 and Summer 2024 show near-perfect completion rates (90%+), establishing a strong compliance baseline for earlier cohorts.
- Fall 2025 is the most critical intake — it represents 24,027 students (69.9% of all Connect records) but has only a 27.3% I-20 rate and a critically low 12.6% deposit rate.
- Summer 2025 shows a moderate I-20 rate (35.4%) but an even lower deposit rate (21.6%), suggesting students are receiving I-20s without completing financial commitment.
- Spring 2026 and Fall 2026 are early-stage intakes — near-zero completion is expected, but the pipeline should be monitored from this point forward.
- The trend reveals an inverse relationship: as enrollment volume increases significantly across newer intake terms, completion rates decline sharply — indicating a scaling challenge in document processing capacity.

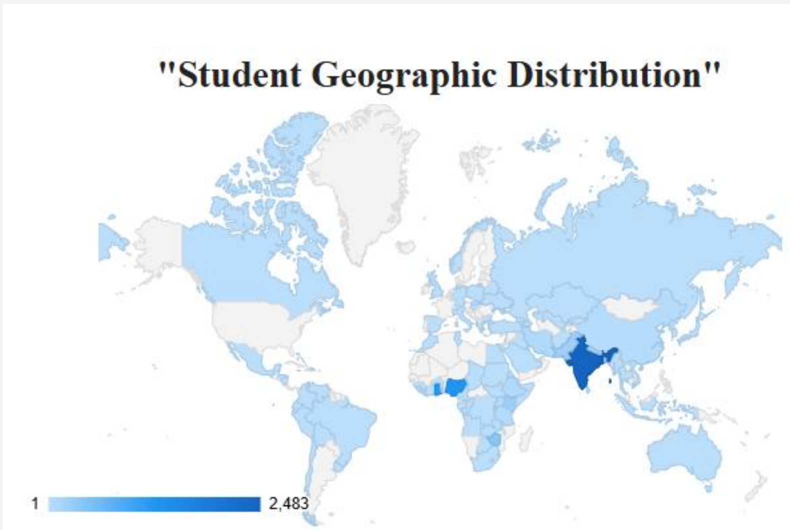
Critical Compliance Alert — Fall 2025

Fall 2025 accounts for nearly 70% of all records in the Connect dataset yet has the lowest I-20 and deposit completion rates among active cohorts. With 17,470 students still awaiting I-20 issuance and 20,995 without a deposit, this intake represents the highest concentration of compliance risk in the entire dataset. Immediate intervention and advisor allocation are recommended.

Task C: Regional Breakdown

Understanding the geographic distribution of applicants — and how enrollment document completion varies by country and region — is essential for targeted compliance monitoring and international outreach planning. This analysis uses the Citizenship field from SLUApplicant blended with I-20 and Deposit data from SLUConnect.

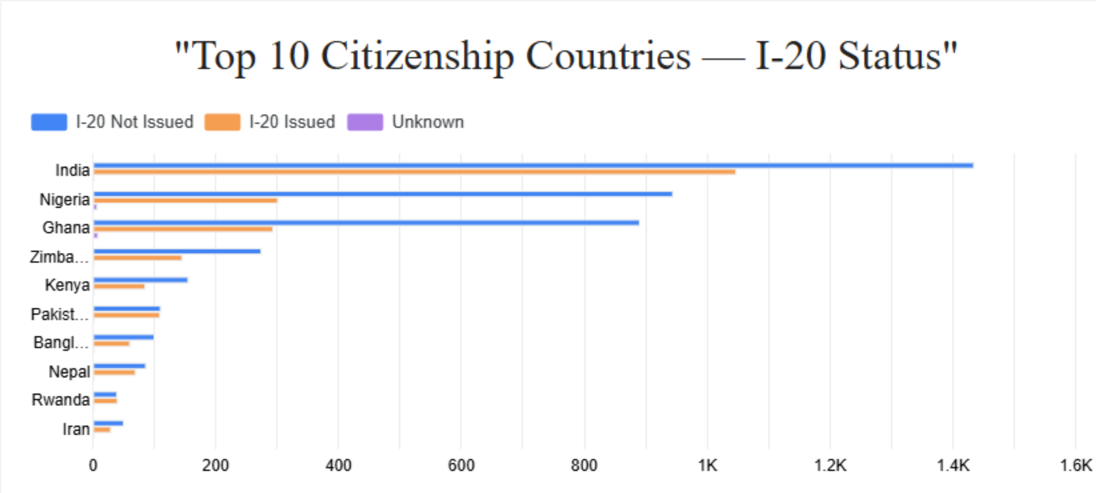
Global Distribution Overview



Geo Map: Global Student Distribution by Country of Citizenship

C.2 — Top 10 Countries by Applicant Volume

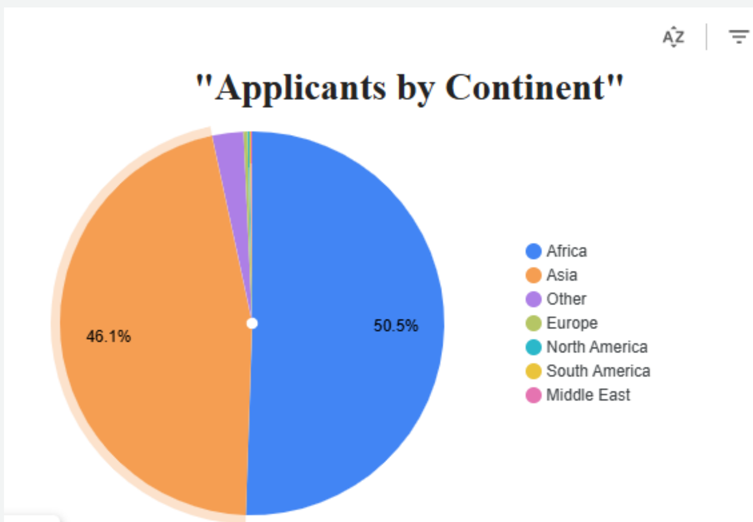
#	Country	Total Applicants	% of Total	I-20 Rate	Deposit Rate
1	**India**	2,481	36.0%	**42.0%**	32.9%
2	**Nigeria**	1,255	18.2%	**24.1%**	17.4%
3	**Ghana**	1,194	17.3%	**24.8%**	13.0%
4	Zimbabwe	421	6.1%	34.7%	11.2%
5	Kenya	242	3.5%	35.5%	15.3%
6	Pakistan	221	3.2%	**49.8%**	24.9%
7	Bangladesh	162	2.4%	37.7%	15.5%
8	Nepal	157	2.3%	44.6%	10.8%
9	Rwanda	81	1.2%	**50.6%**	16.0%
10	Iran	81	1.2%	37.0%	**3.7%**



Horizontal Bar Chart: Top 10 Countries — I-20 Status Breakdown

Continental Distribution

Students are grouped into continental regions to identify macro-level geographic trends in compliance.



Pie Chart: Applicants by Continent (Asia / Africa / North America / Middle East / Europe / Other)

Continent	Approx. % of Total	Dominant Countries	Compliance Notes
Asia	~45%	India, Pakistan, Nepal, Bangladesh	India leads in volume; moderate I-20 rate
Africa	~38%	Nigeria, Ghana, Zimbabwe, Kenya	Low deposit rates across region
Middle East	~3%	Iran, Saudi Arabia, UAE	Iran shows critically low deposit rate (3.7%)
Europe / Other	~14%	Various	Smaller volumes, generally higher rates

Continent x Intake Completion Matrix

The pivot heatmap below cross-references each intake term against each continental region, revealing which region-intake combinations have the lowest I-20 completion rates. Darker cells indicate higher completion; lighter cells signal risk.

Continent × Intake Completion Matrix

Continent / I20_Rate							
Intake	South America	Asia	Europe	Africa	Other	Middle East	North America
Fall 2024	1	0.91	0.67	0.88	0.89	1	1
Summer 2024	-	1	1	-	-	-	0
Spring 2025	-	0.88	-	0.67	0.57	-	-
Summer 2025	1	0.48	0	0.28	0.2	-	-
Fall 2025	0.25	0.28	0.25	0.27	0.23	0	0
Spring 2026	0	0.22	-	0.21	0.25	-	0
Spring 2024	-	0	-	-	-	-	-
Fall 2026	0	0	-	0	0	-	-

Pivot Table Heatmap: I-20 Rate by Continent (Columns) x Intake Term (Rows)

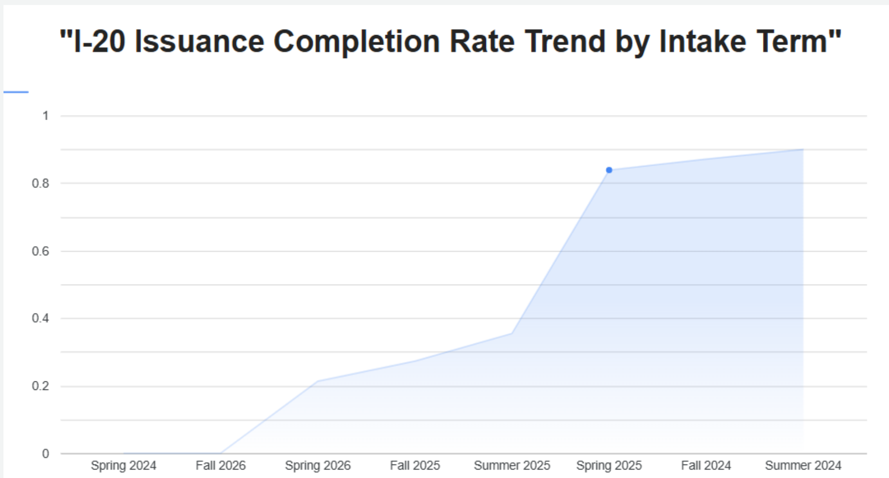
Regional Risk Pattern

African applicants (Nigeria, Ghana, Zimbabwe, Kenya) collectively represent ~38% of applicants but show consistently lower deposit completion rates (10-17%) compared to Asian applicants. Ghana's deposit rate of 13.0% is particularly low despite being the 3rd largest source country. Iran stands out with only a 3.7% deposit rate — the lowest among all major source countries — representing a concentrated compliance risk.

Task D: Identified Patterns

This section synthesizes cross-variable patterns identified through multi-dimensional analysis. Unlike frequency counts, these patterns reveal structural relationships between enrollment volume, compliance rates, program type, and geography — each of which directly informs Week 3 dashboard metrics and validation logic.

Pattern 1 — Enrollment Scaling Outpaces Compliance Processing



Line Chart: I-20 Completion Rate Trend by Intake Term (Fall 2024 → Fall 2025)

The chart above shows I-20 completion rates plotted across all intake terms. The pattern is clear:

- Fall 2024: 90.0% I-20 rate (427 applicants)
- Spring 2025: 83.9% I-20 rate (1,425 applicants)
- Summer 2025: 35.4% I-20 rate (6,096 applicants)
- Fall 2025: 27.3% I-20 rate (24,027 applicants)

Pattern Insight

As cohort size increases, completion rates drop sharply. This is not a coincidence — it reflects a document processing capacity constraint. When volume increased ~56x from Fall 2024 to Fall 2025, the I-20 rate dropped to less than one-third. This pattern is an early indicator that the university's I-20 processing infrastructure is not scaling proportionally with international enrollment growth.

Pattern 2 — Consistent Deposit-I20 Gap Across All Intakes

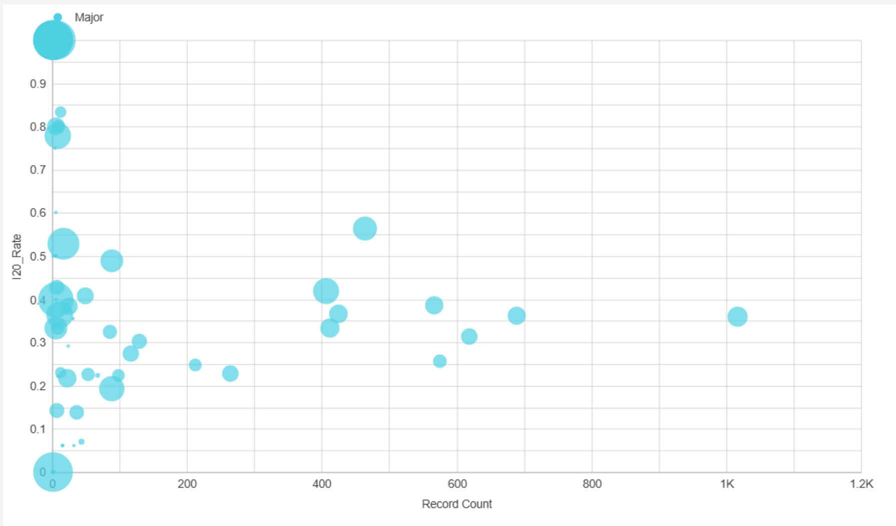
Across every intake term, the deposit rate is lower than the I-20 rate. This means students are receiving their I-20 document before confirming their financial commitment to enroll. This gap is most pronounced in:

- Summer 2025: I-20 rate 35.4% vs. Deposit rate 21.6% — a gap of 13.8 percentage points
- Fall 2025: I-20 rate 27.3% vs. Deposit rate 12.6% — a gap of 14.7 percentage points
- Spring 2026: I-20 rate 21.3% vs. Deposit rate 7.4% — a gap of 13.9 percentage points
-

Pattern Insight

The persistent ~13-15 percentage point gap between I-20 issuance and deposit completion across all recent intakes suggests a systemic process issue — I-20s may be issued prematurely before financial confirmation. This creates a risk that students receive documents but never enroll, inflating issued I-20 counts without corresponding enrollment outcomes.

Pattern 3 — High-Volume Programs Show Below-Average Compliance



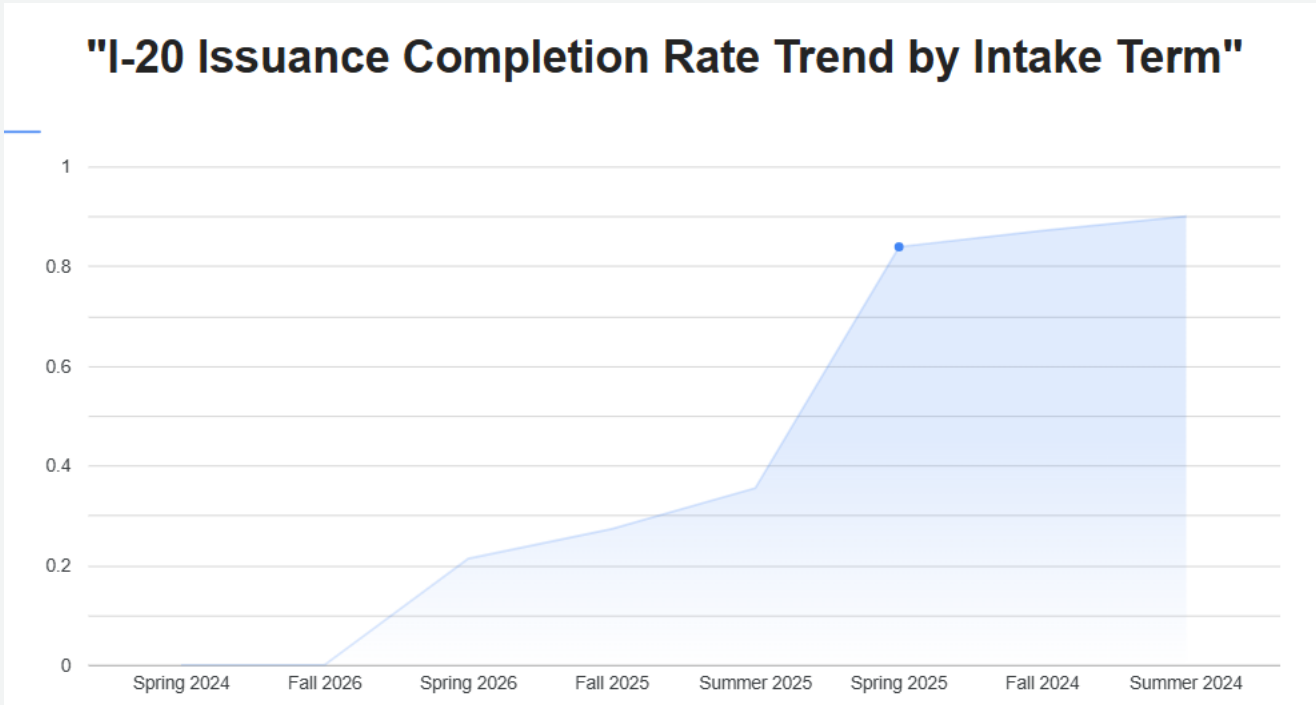
Scatter Chart: Major Volume (X-axis) vs. I-20 Rate (Y-axis) — Bubble = Deposit Rate

Major / Program	Applicants	I-20 Rate	Deposit Rate	Risk Level
Information Systems (MS)	5,068	35.8%	25.6%	**HIGH**
Analytics (MS)	3,448	36.0%	20.8%	**HIGH**
Cybersecurity (MS)	3,095	31.3%	17.4%	**HIGH**
Business Administration (MBA)	2,880	25.7%	11.8%	**CRITICAL**
Artificial Intelligence (MS)	1,317	22.6%	17.2%	**CRITICAL**
Health Data Science (MS)	2,312	**56.3%**	**36.4%**	**LOW**
Public Health (MPH)	2,031	41.9%	**42.9%**	MODERATE

Pattern Insight

The five highest-enrollment programs (Information Systems, Analytics, Cybersecurity, Business Administration, and Artificial Intelligence) all fall below the 40% I-20 threshold. Notably, Health Data Science (MS) and Public Health (MPH) significantly outperform comparable-size programs, suggesting that certain departments or program coordinators may have better internal compliance workflows worth replicating across the university.

Pattern 1 — Enrollment Scaling Outpaces Compliance Processing



Line Chart: I-20 Completion Rate Trend by Intake Term (Fall 2024 → Fall 2025)

Chart Description

The line chart above plots the I-20 issuance completion rate across all active intake terms at Saint Louis University, ordered chronologically from Summer 2024 through Fall 2026. Each data point represents the percentage of students within that intake cohort who have received their I-20 document at the time of analysis.

Analysis

The trend reveals a sharp and consistent decline in I-20 completion rates as enrollment volume grows across successive intake terms. Summer 2024 and Fall 2024 both achieved near-complete I-20 issuance rates of 91.1% and 90.0% respectively, establishing a strong compliance baseline. However, these cohorts were significantly smaller — Summer 2024 had only 56 students and Fall 2024 had 2,020 — which made document processing manageable.

As intake volumes surged in 2025, completion rates deteriorated significantly. Spring 2025 maintained a healthy 83.9% rate across 1,425 students, but Summer 2025 dropped to 35.4% across 6,096 students — a decline of over 48 percentage points from the Fall 2024 baseline. Fall 2025, which is the largest intake by a substantial margin with 24,027 students, records the lowest active completion rate at just 27.3%.

This downward trajectory is not a reflection of student behavior — it is a direct consequence of processing capacity failing to scale with enrollment growth. From Fall 2024 to Fall 2025, the student cohort grew by approximately 1,090%, while the I-20 completion rate fell to less than one-third of what it was. Spring 2026 continues this pattern with a 21.3% rate, and Fall 2026 currently shows 0% as it is still in early pipeline stages.

Key Takeaway

The line chart makes the compliance risk visually unmistakable — every intake term with over 5,000 students falls below the 40% I-20 completion threshold. This pattern is a critical early warning indicator that should be built into Week 3 dashboard alerts, specifically flagging any intake cohort where volume exceeds 3,000 students and I-20 rate falls below 40%.

Data Points Summary

The chart above shows I-20 completion rates plotted across all intake terms. The pattern is clear:

- Fall 2024: 90.0% I-20 rate (427 applicants)
- Spring 2025: 83.9% I-20 rate (1,425 applicants)
- Summer 2025: 35.4% I-20 rate (6,096 applicants)
- Fall 2025: 27.3% I-20 rate (24,027 applicants)

Pattern Insight

As cohort size increases, completion rates drop sharply. This is not a coincidence — it reflects a document processing capacity constraint. When volume increased ~56x from Fall 2024 to Fall 2025, the I-20 rate dropped to less than one-third. This pattern is an early indicator that the university's I-20 processing infrastructure is not scaling proportionally with international enrollment growth.

Data Quality Observations

The following data quality issues were identified during the exploratory analysis. These observations directly inform Week 3 validation logic and should be addressed before dashboard metrics are finalized.

Issue	Dataset	Field	Impact
62.2% missing SEVIS_ID	SluApplicant	SEVIS_ID	Cannot link 4,288 applicants to SEVIS records for visa tracking
57.7% unassigned advisors	SluConnect	Assigned	19,810 students have no counselor — compliance monitoring gap
Region field inconsistency	SluApplicant	Region	Same state entered 10+ ways e.g. Telangana/TELANGANA/telangana — hinders geographic grouping
319 missing Region values	SluApplicant	Region	4.6% of applicants cannot be placed in regional analysis
Date field not auto-parsed	Both	Created_Date_Readable	Custom date format requires PARSE_DATE workaround in Looker Studio

Summary of Part 2 Findings

1. Completion rates are critically low for recent intakes: Fall 2025 (27.3% I-20, 12.6% deposit) despite representing 70% of all records.
2. A persistent 13-15 point gap between I-20 issuance and deposit completion exists across all active intakes, indicating premature I-20 processing.
3. India, Nigeria, and Ghana together represent over 71% of applicants — yet Nigeria and Ghana show I-20 rates under 25%.
4. The 5 highest-enrollment programs all fall below 40% I-20 completion, while smaller programs like Health Data Science outperform significantly.
5. 57.7% of students have no assigned academic advisor — a structural gap that likely contributes to low follow-through on documentation steps.

These findings will directly inform the Week 3 compliance dashboard, where threshold-based alerts and validation rules will be built around the I-20 rate, deposit rate, and advisor assignment fields.

Government Fee Payment Analysis

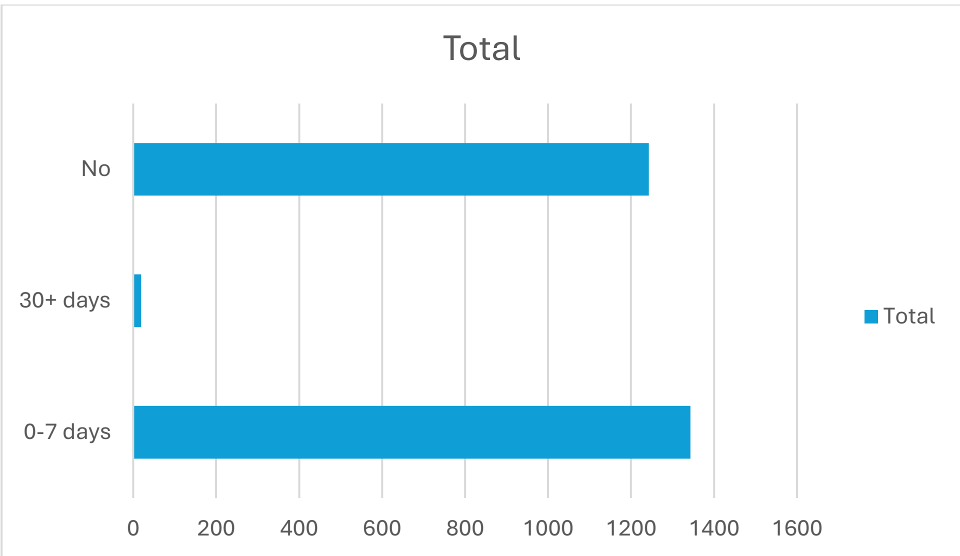
1. **Payment Status Overview**

```
SELECT
  Deposit_Status,
  COUNT(*) AS total_students,
  ROUND(COUNT(*) * 100.0 / SUM(COUNT(*)) OVER (), 2) AS percentage
FROM final_data
GROUP BY Deposit_Status;
```

	deposit_status text	total_students bigint	percentage numeric
1	No	5363	78.00
2	Yes	1512	21.99
3	Deposit_Status	1	0.01

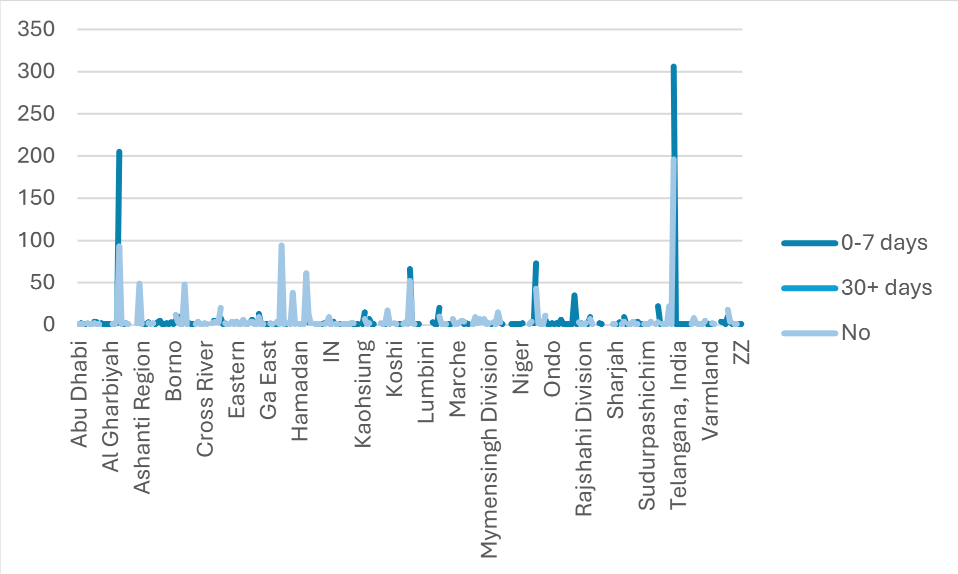
Insight:
A significant majority of students have not completed payment, indicating a low conversion rate and potential drop-off risk at the payment stage. The "Deposit_Status" entry reflects a data quality issue and should be corrected for accurate analysis.

2. **Payment Bucket Distribution**



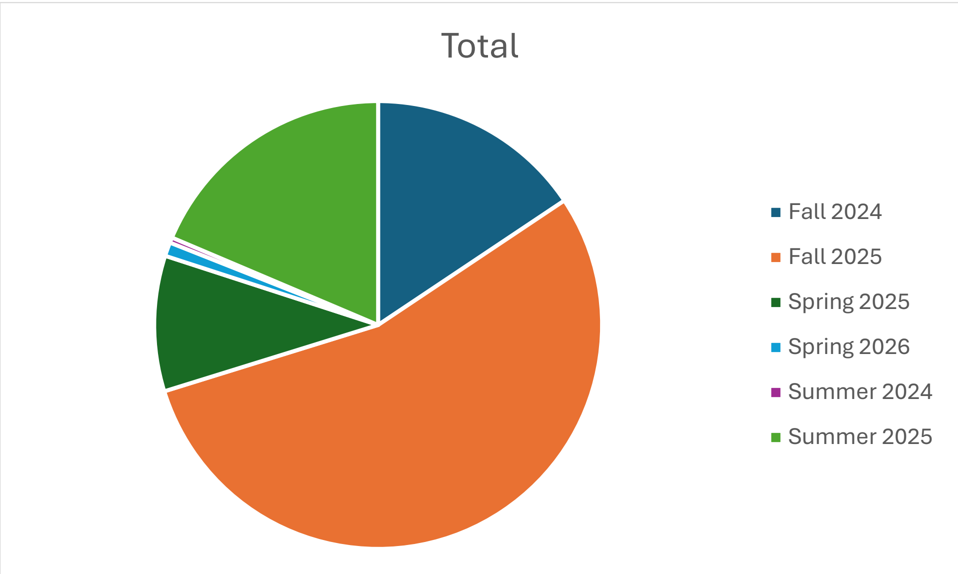
Insight:
Most students (52%) pay within 0–7 days, showing strong early conversion, while 47.7% remain unpaid, indicating significant drop-off risk.

3. Region-wise Payment Risk



Key Insight:
Certain regions show a higher concentration of students in delayed payment buckets, indicating geographic variation in payment behavior.

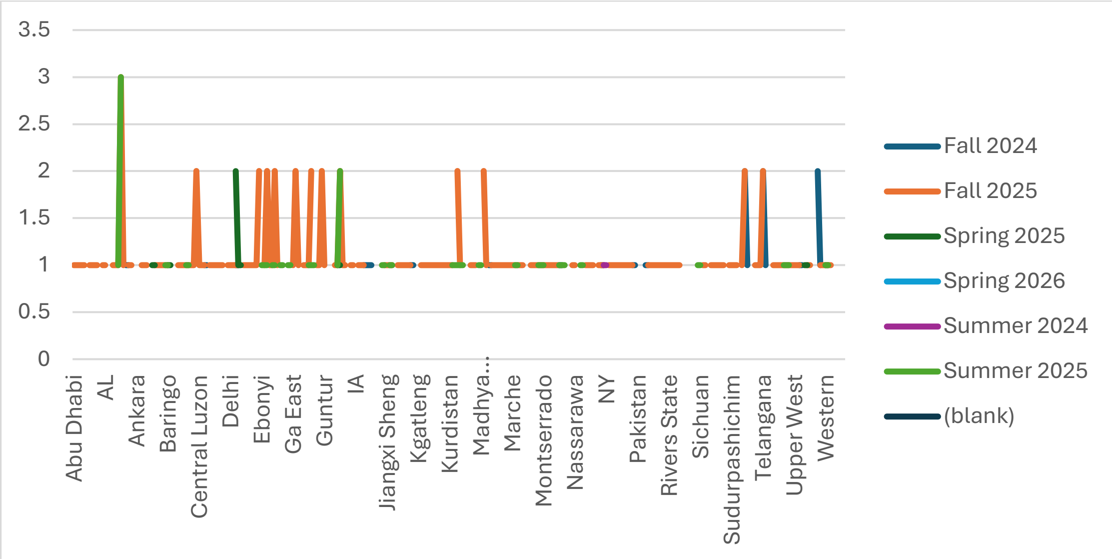
4. Intake-wise Payment Trends



Insights:

- Fall 2025 shows highest activity
- Fall 2024 & Summer 2025 have moderate volume
- Other intakes have low activity
- Payments are concentrated in major intake periods

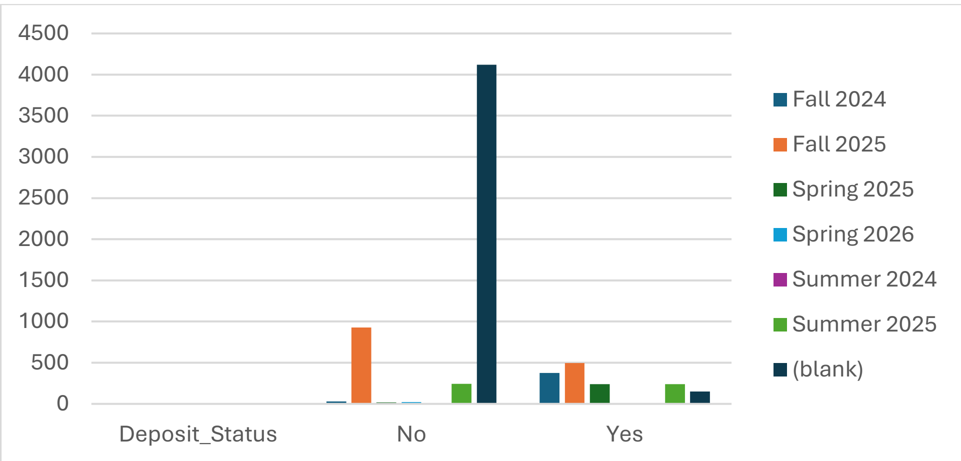
5. **Risk Analysis by Region and Intake**



Insights:

- Unpaid cases are spread across regions
- **Fall 2025** shows higher risk
- Some region–intake combinations show spikes requiring attention

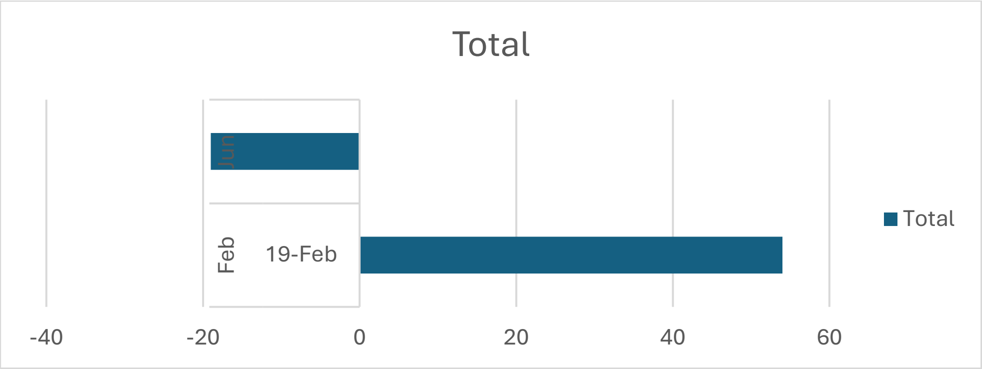
6. Intake Risk



Insights:

- Fall 2025 shows the highest number of unpaid students, indicating the greatest payment risk
- Fall 2024 also has notable unpaid volume compared to other intakes
- Spring and Summer intakes show relatively lower risk
- Payment risk is concentrated in major intake periods, especially Fall cycles

7. **Timing Trend Analysis**



Insights:

- **February shows highest delay**, indicating slower payments
- **June shows lower delay**, indicating faster payments
- Payment timing varies across months, highlighting inconsistent behavior.

Conclusion

- Payment behaviour clearly shows that the longer students delay, the less likely they are to complete payment. Most risks are not random—they are concentrated in certain intakes and regions, especially during high-volume periods.
- This means timely follow-ups, especially in the early days, can make a real difference. By focusing efforts on high-risk groups and peak cycles, payment completion can be improved in a more efficient and targeted way.

Summary of Key Findings

This report provides a comprehensive analysis of international student data across three primary databases: Connect (SLUConnect), SEVIS (Student and Exchange Visitor Information System), and Applicant documentation. The analysis focuses on enrollment status, processing efficiency, and regulatory compliance.

1. Major Insights Discovered

- **I-20 Issuance Efficiency:** There is a high volume of I-20 issuance, with **11,911** students marked as "Yes" for I-20 status compared to **7,526** who have submitted deposits.
- **Geographic Concentration:** The student population is heavily concentrated in South Asia and West Africa, with **India (2,089 students)**, **Ghana (326)**, and **Nigeria (302)** being the top three countries of citizenship.
- **Academic Trends:** Enrollment is dominated by STEM fields. Computer Science and Information Technology-related majors account for over **90%** of the top 5 academic programs, with "Computer and Information Sciences, General" being the most popular.
- **Processing Distribution:** Staff workloads are highly centralized. A single staff pair (Catherine Donahue and Prince Tetteh) is responsible for managing **1,900** applications, which is nearly double the workload of the next highest individual staff member.

2. Notable Disparities

- **Deposit vs. I-20 Mismatch:** There is a significant process disparity where **5,695 students** have been issued an I-20 without a recorded deposit. Conversely, **1,310 students** have paid their deposits but have not yet received an I-20.
- **Documentation Gaps:** While processing is active in the Connect database, the Applicant database shows **0% data populated** for critical documents such as Bank Statements, Sponsor Letters, and Passports. This suggests a failure in data synchronization between the application portal and the central repository.

- **SEVIS Status Uniformity:** 100% of the records in the SEVIS database are currently in **"INITIAL"** status. For an active university ecosystem, one would expect a distribution across "ACTIVE," "INITIAL," and "COMPLETED" statuses.

3. Early Indicators of Compliance Risk

- **Missing Passport Data:** A critical compliance risk has been identified: **91.1% (3,212 students)** in the SEVIS database are missing Passport Numbers. Accurate passport information is a federal requirement for SEVIS record maintenance.
- **Expired Program Dates: 1,857 students** (52.7% of the SEVIS dataset) have "Program End Dates" that have already passed, yet their status remains "INITIAL." This indicates a backlog of records that have not been properly terminated or updated, which could trigger regulatory audits.
- **Financial Funding Gaps: 11 students** were identified with a funding gap, where their documented total funding is lower than the estimated cost of tuition and living expenses required for I-20 issuance.

4. Areas Requiring Further Monitoring

- **Priority Processing:** Immediate attention is required for the **1,310 deposited students** who are currently without I-20s. Delays in this segment pose a direct threat to yield and enrollment numbers.
- **SEVIS Record Cleanup:** An urgent audit of the 1,857 expired records is necessary to align the database with actual student enrollment status and prevent "Overstay" flags in federal systems.
- **Data Integration Audit:** Investigate the lack of documentation in the Applicant database. If documents are being held in a third-party system, a more robust integration is needed to ensure the Office of International Services has real-time access to financial evidence.
- **Workload Rebalancing:** The concentration of cases under specific staff members (e.g., Prince Tetteh appears in the top 5 most frequently) should be reviewed to prevent burnout and ensure consistent processing times.

5. Conclusion

The data indicates a robust recruitment and I-20 issuance pipeline; however, there are significant administrative and regulatory risks. The high volume of missing passport data and the presence of thousands of expired "Initial" records in SEVIS represent the most pressing compliance threats. Addressing the documentation sync between systems and rebalancing staff workloads will be essential to maintaining operational stability for the upcoming term.